Fiscal Year:	FY 2023	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 01/19/2023
PI Name:	Bell, Suzanne Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Human Factors and Behavioral Performance Exploration Measures in HERA		
Division Name:	Human Research		
Program/Discipline:			
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:			
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	(1) **HFBP**:Human Factors & Behavioral Performance (IRP Rev H)		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	None		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	None		
Space Biology Special Category:	None		
PI Email:	suzanne.t.bell@nasa.gov	**Fax:**	FY
PI Organization Type:	NASA CENTER	**Phone:**	
Organization Name:	NASA Johnson Space Center		
PI Address 1:	2101 E NASA Pkwy		
PI Address 2:	SK311		
PI Web Page:			
City:	Houston	**State:**	TX
Zip Code:	77058	**Congressional District:**	36
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	Directed Research
Start Date:	03/01/2021	**End Date:**	01/31/2026
No. of Post Docs:	0	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	0
No. of PhD Candidates:	2	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	0
No. of Master's Candidates:	0	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	0
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA JSC
Contact Monitor:	Whitmire, Alexandra	**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:	alexandra.m.whitmire@nasa.gov		
Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:	NOTE: End date changed to 01/31/2026 per A. Beitman/JSC (Ed., 11/13/23).		
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:	December 2022 report: Steven R. Anderson, PhD was added as a CoInvestigator (CoI). Per PI: Sara Whiting, Ph.D. moved from the Lab to a new role and is no longer a CoI (Ed., 4/5/23). December 2021 report: Sheena I. Dev, PhD, was added as CoI in May 2021.		
COI Name (Institution):	Landon, Lauren Ph.D. (BHP Laboratory, KBR/NASA Johnson Space Center) Dev, Sheena Ph.D. (BHP Laboratory, KBR/NASA Johnson Space Center) Anderson, Steven (BHP Laboratory, KBR/NASA Johnson Space Center)		
Grant/Contract No.:	Directed Research		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			

Task Description:

NOTE (9/30/2021): Continuation of "Human Factors and Behavioral Performance Exploration Measures in HERA (previous title: Identification and Validation of BHP Standard Measures in HERA for Transport)"--PI Dr. Peter Roma, who moved to Naval Research Laboratory (NRL) in early 2021. With Dr. Roma's move to the NRL in early 2021, Dr. Suzanne Bell is now Principal Investigator.
NASA's Human Research Program (HRP) is developing a set of "Standard Measures" for use in spaceflight and analogs. These "standard measures" need to be validated in analog settings to ensure their validity, acceptability, and reliability in helping identify and measure indicators of risk associated with crew health and performance. Exploration missions are anticipated to create isolated and confined environments that will include stressors such as small teams living and working in extreme conditions for prolonged periods separated from family, friends; loss of the day/light cycle; loss or delay of communications with ground; partial gravity; and limited space, privacy, and food selection. HRP's Human Factors and Behavioral Performance (HFBP) Element seeks to maintain and enhance behavioral health and performance in such environments. The Behavioral Medicine risk (Risk of Adverse Behavioral or Behavioral Conditions and Psychiatric Disorders) is a high priority within the HRP because psychological and behavioral health factors reveal intra- and inter-individual variability. This variability poses significant challenge for measurement of risk and resilience in crews and individual astronauts during long-duration missions.

The HFBP-EM (Exploration Measures) will build upon the initial use and identification of Behavioral Core Measures (BCM), whose purpose was to evaluate the feasibility and acceptability of these outcome measures (Dinges; NNJ13ZSA002N-BMED; project title: "Standardized Behavioral Measures for Detecting Behavioral Health Risks during Exploration Missions") in high fidelity analogs. The task proposed here provides an opportunity to continue using standardized measures in order to operationalize their efficiency and effectiveness, ensure consistent measurement of these key metrics, and facilitate the analysis and understanding of these measures in assessing risk. The development and use of these expanded standardized measures are needed now to develop astronaut norms in order to determine their efficacy and ability to objectively detect, assess, and manage off nominal events; and predict future off nominal events that may compromise a mission and increase the risk of behavioral health and performance decrements. This advances our need for individualized, real-time tools that provide rapid feedback and assessment that are needed for exploration class missions. The use of BHP (Behavioral Health and Performance) Standard Measures across analogs and analog missions, allows NASA Human Research Program (HRP) to determine a baseline for assessing and monitoring specific countermeasures; and increases the construct and predictive validity of countermeasures for assessing risk and for their monitoring of behavioral health and performance in spaceflight.

Specific Aims include:

Aim 1. Provide a set of BHP standard measurements for investigators to use in proposed projects. Significance: This allows NASA HRP to streamline and make more efficient the use of multiple measurements collected on research participants during analog research and helps to ensure a reduced burden on these research participants by using a "standard" set of measures for data sharing by multiple principal investigators (PIs).

Aim 2. Enable comparison of multiple missions across spaceflight analog campaigns to quantify risk using reliable metric-based data. Significance: The "standardized measures" increase the generalization of findings across research analogs, increasing the validity and reliability of measures used to quantify, characterize, and assess the impact of spacelike analogs on prevalence of behavioral health issues, incidence rates, longer term health, and performance errors. This allows generation of reliable and sensitive metrics that can be used systematically to inform accurate risk assessment and mitigation status for future exploration spaceflight missions.

Aim 3. Provide database for data-mining and integrative modeling and increase research data quality and transfer to the Life Sciences Data Archive (LSDA). Significance: Collection of "Standardized Measures" allows for greater consistency and fidelity of data collected, enhancing the data archiving capabilities of analog outcomes, increasing accessibility of data for NASA use, metrics assessment associated with red to yellow, and yellow to green risk status, and trending, and increasing the probability that the standardized set of measures are appropriately archived in a timely manner. Although data management agreements require PIs to submit their data after completion of their research, the exact format and timeliness of that data submission varies greatly among PIs. The collection of "standardized measures" via internal directed studies helps to ensure more timely, valid, and accessible data resources to help guide risk reduction.

NOTES 2018 August: Original Principal Investigator (PI) was Thomas J. Williams, PhD, who became HRP Human Factors & Behavioral Performance (HFBP) Element Scientist shortly after the award was made; Jason S. Schneiderman, Ph.D. served as interim PI until July 10, 2017, when Peter G. Roma, Ph.D. came to Johnson Space Center and became Principal Investigator. At that time, title was changed to "Identification and Validation of BHP Standard Measures in HERA for Transport" (original title was "Identification and Validation of BHP Standard Measures").

2020 February: Project title was changed to "Human Factors and Behavioral Performance Exploration Measures in HERA" (Short Title: HFBP-EM in HERA).

Rationale for HRP Directed Research:

This research is directed because NASA must define complete scientific activities in a short time and there is insufficient time to issue a solicitation. This task is in direct response to both the August 2014 Human Subjects Review Board (HSRB) requirement and the baselined Human Research Program (HRP) Path to Risk Reduction milestone of providing standard measures to monitor crew health and performance. This will allow HRP to establish, evaluate, and manage a common set of measures for use in spaceflight and analog research to: develop baselines, systematically characterize risk likelihood and consequences, and assess effectiveness of countermeasures that work for human factors and behavioral performance risk factors. This proposal qualifies for a directed study due to the urgent, time-sensitive need to provide "standard measures" as the foundation to achieve consistent research measure for data-sharing in HERA (Human Exploration Research Analog) and to meet the highly constrained, operationally-focused data gathering and analysis that allows for greater consistency in the research methods that are specific to NASA HRP standard measures development. Additionally, the set of Behavioral Health and Performance (BHP) standardized measures in the HERA analogy reflects the more operational nature of the measures while allowing the multiple and frequent internal and external collaborations required to execute this study. The directed nature of this study also allows NASA to provide the unique research and support expertise that is needed to integrate and manage the data from all of the various participating studies to achieve HRP's intent and support to the Flight Analogs Project (FAP) within a highly constrained time schedule. Completion of the required research, support to both analog and operational requirements, and vetting of

	the evidence-based standards makes the solicitation process prohibitive. In addition, our group, the BHP Lab has already performed similar work across various analogs in support of previous NASA research and the use of the BHP Lab offers considerable efficiencies that are realized by building upon our existing work and that expertise. Finally, two panels of extramural subject matter experts with experience in critical task identification in academic, military, and spaceflight analog settings met at Johnson Space Center (JSC) and provided recommendations consistent with the enclosed project related to team processes (November 2015) and psychometric assessment of cognition (April 2016).
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	HFBP Exploration Measures provides a comprehensive understanding of the behavioral medicine and team dynamics in isolated and confined settings. Increasingly, the American population is isolated from friends, family, and coworkers due to quarantine and remote work. In addition, there are special populations such as prisoners and nursing home residents who can encounter extended separation from family and friends. Our research provides insights into the psychological impact of isolation and confinement as well as how the circumstance can shape relational and team dynamics over time.
Task Progress:	Over the past year, the BHP Laboratory has made tremendous progress in four primary areas: (1) data collection and processing from the first three missions of HERA (Human Exploration Research Analog) Campaign 6; (2) completion of the Human Factors Behavioral Performance – Exploration Measures (HFBP-EM) harmonization project; (3) continued validation of HFBP-EM short form measures in HERA Campaign 6; and (4) protocol development for HERA Campaign 7. First, we have made significant progress in the data collection, cleaning, processing, and analysis of the HFBP-EM from HERA Campaign 6, except for Mission 4, which was delayed to January 2023. Careless responses on surveys were identified and flagged. Actigraphy and heart rate data were processed according to best practices, and sleep and heart rate metrics were summarized as daily aggregates. Data from objective performance tasks were transformed, and key performance metrics were extracted. A set of meta-data variables (e.g., mission, participant ID, mission day) were generated to define key variables with which data could be merged across missions for future analyses. Data were merged across multiple missions to inform analyses for the further development of shorter forms of some measures and to add to the recently completed HFBP-EM Harmonization project. Second, we completed the Harmonization project and submitted a report to the HFBP Element which synthesized HFBP-EM data from HERA Campaigns 4 and 5 with data from the SIRIUS 19 mission in the Russian Ground Based Experiment Complex (NEK). In addition, a subset of the HFBP-EM suite was collected in spaceflight as part of the Human Research Program (HRP) Standard Measures in Spaceflight Project. The purpose of this task was to develop a harmonized database of analyzable HFBP-EM data from spaceflight and analog settings and to summarize the trajectory of behavioral health and performance outcomes within and between research settings. We followed best practices for data harmonization to create harmonized individual-level and team-level datasets designed to facilitate analyses for HFBP-related risks (HFBP-EM Harmonization Task; PI: Bell). We wrote and delivered an easy-to-navigate and comprehensive 175-page report to the HFBP Element (see Bell et al., 2022). Third, we are continuing to validate HFBP-EM short forms that we have developed in HERA C6, continuing through Mission 4 in early 2023. This effort involves the evaluation of our existing HFBP-EM surveys with special consideration for small sample sizes and small team sizes. These efforts will culminate in a high-level report of our short-form validation efforts. This effort builds upon previous BHP Laboratory efforts to assess the reliability and validity of the standard-length surveys included in the HFBP-EM suite and identify key measurement gaps across instruments. The results of these analyses were then used to develop shorter versions of several measures in the exploration measures suite. The short-form surveys are intended to decrease participant burden, improve spaceflight operational acceptability, and improve behavioral medicine and team risk assessment. Finally, we are preparing for HERA Campaign 7. We submitted an IRB protocol modification on December 15, 2022. For HERA Campaign 7, we proposed research for 5 primary objectives: (1) continue HFBP-EM data collection through HERA Campaign 7; (2) develop and test a refined wearable protocol for heart rate (HR) and heart rate variability (HRV) data collection; (3) summarize the extent to which contributing factors (e.g., stressors such as off-nominal emergency events) shape key BMed and Team risk metrics including mood, cognition, cooperation, coordination, communication, and operationally-relevant performance; (4) determine thresholds for key BMed and Team risk metrics including perceived stress, perceived workload, cognition (PVT and DSST), and cooperation, coordination, and communication; and (5) provide baseline data on perceived connectedness between crewmembers and family under conditions of communication delay.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 08/01/2025)
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bell ST, Dev SI, Miller J, Whiting S, Landon LB, Begerowski S, Khader A. "Human Factors and Behavioral Performance Exploration Measures (HFBP-EM) harmonized across HERA, NEK, and ISS." Final Report. Internal Report. , Jan-2022
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bell, ST, Miller JCW, Whiting SE, Landon LB, Dev SI, Begerowski SR, Doerr A, Roma P. "Development and initial validation of HFBP-EM short-form surveys." 2022 NASA Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop, Virtual. Poster. , Jan-2022
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bell ST, Dev SI, Whiting SE, Miller JCW, Khader AM, Roma P. "Human factors and behavioral performance exploration measures harmonized across HERA, NEK, and ISS: Behavioral medicine risk." 2022 NASA Human Research Program Investigators' Workshop, Virtual. Presentation. , Jan-2022
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Bell ST, Dev SI, Whiting SE, Landon LB, Miller JCW, Khader AM. "Human factors and behavioral performance exploration measures: Assessing astronaut risk." 92nd Annual Scientific Meeting of the Aerospace Medical Association, Reno, NV, United States. Presentation. , May-2022

Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Dev SI, Whiting S, Miller JCW, Young M, Roma PG, Bell ST. "The impact of mood and affect on operationally relevant performance among astronaut-like individuals in space analog settings." 92nd Annual Scientific Meeting of the Aerospace Medical Association, Reno, NV, United States. Presentation. , May-2022
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Landon LB. "Risk of performance and behavioral health decrements due to inadequate cooperation, coordination, and psychosocial adaptations within a Team." NASA. Updated Evidence Book. , Jan-2022